



GoT S8 breaks piracy record

'Game of Thrones' was pirated more than a billion times – far more than it was watched legally. <https://digit.in/may19-25>



LIDAR is a fool's errand: Musk

Elon Musk says anyone relying on lidar is doomed, they are expensive unnecessary sensors. <https://digit.in/may19-26>

Huawei P30 Pro

Taking smartphone photography to the next level

Huawei's P30 Pro launched to much fanfare and hype at an event hosted in Paris. After a brief hands-on with the phone, we eventually got a chance to test every aspect of the device thoroughly.

Build and Design

The only real interruption to the front is the dew-drop shaped notch on top. On the back, there is a gradient of blue and green, which you should cover with the TPU case bundled. The phone is also IP68 rated. Overall, the Huawei P30 Pro's build and design is definitely something we've come to like.

Display

The Huawei P30 Pro supports the DCI-P3 colour profile for wide-gamut colour, meaning that, you could watch HDR videos on this panel. The display is sufficiently bright to be able to use it for reading or watching videos outdoors. The curved display definitely needs better palm rejection in order to make one-handed use easier. The only notable let-down with the P30 Pro's display is the FHD+ resolution.

Call Quality

We found that while the piezoelectric speaker itself offered impressive audio levels and good clarity, the microphone too worked well to filter out ambient noise and deliver clean audio even to the person on the other end of the line. Even in this department, there's not much to complain about.

Performance and Battery

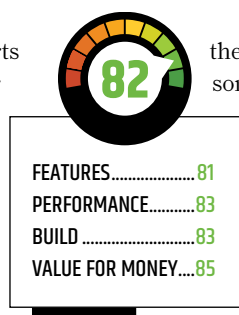
While the benchmark numbers do put the P30 Pro behind the Samsung Galaxy S10+, on a day to day basis, the story is somewhat different. The Kirin 980-powered phone offers adequate performance for any task you may throw at it, whether it's gaming, photo editing or even conducting business. The phone charges its 4100mAh battery from 0 – 100 in 71 minutes flat with the bundled charger and cable.

Primary Camera

The RYYB sensor has shown to be immensely effective in low light, capturing shots in practically pitch-dark situations. The ultra-wide 16mm lens on

the P30 Pro is again prone to some distortion as will always be the case with wide angle lenses, but thanks to the presence of auto-focus, allows for more flexible use of the camera. The telephoto lens is another hero feature of the P30 Pro, offering 5x optical

zoom thanks to Leica's periscope design which allowed the company to fit a long lens into a relatively thin body. The 10x hybrid zoom extends this to 270mm, and delivers surprisingly clean images as long as they're shot in a good light. The 50x zoom is interesting but requires the phone to be absolutely stable for shots to be borderline usable. The only delay experienced was when we chose to shoot in Pro mode with RAW capture enabled, which is expected as RAW files are quite big.



Selfie Camera

The front camera does take sharp, vibrant images in the day time. The camera is able to expose properly even for backlit subjects, which is really helpful when you don't have control on the direction you're shooting in. Low light selfies are usable but have significant detail loss due to the noise reduction that occurs.

Bottomline

The Huawei P30 Pro is the most expensive Huawei smartphone to date and to some, it may be hard to justify the price. What the phone does get right is the camera performance, which sets a new benchmark in our tests. The Leica lenses produce sharp, crisp images when paired with the right shooting conditions, however, the primary camera manages to impress us even in impossible lighting.

On our performance benchmarks, the phone doesn't clock numbers as high as the Exynos 9820 powered Samsung Galaxy S10+, but does outperform the older Huawei Mate 20 Pro which is powered by the same Kirin 980 chipset. The phone has not only excellent battery life but also tops up very quickly, as long as you use the supplied charger and cable.

The only flaw we feel is the FHD+ display, whose resolution should have been higher, especially for the asking price. Additionally, the 256GB of storage may not be enough for photographers who want to shoot extensively in RAW, a problem that is heightened by the fact that even though the P30 Pro offers expandable storage, you will have to use Huawei's proprietary nano-memory cards, which are not sold in India as yet.

–Swapnil Mathur

SPECIFICATIONS

WIDTH: 73.4 mm | HEIGHT: 158.0 mm | DEPTH: 8.41 mm | WEIGHT: 192 g | DISPLAY: OLED FHD+ 2340 x 1080 | PROCESSOR: HUAWEI Kirin 980 | MEMORY: 8 GB RAM + 256 GB ROM | REAR CAMERA: Leica Quad camera | FRONT CAMERA: 32 MP, f/2.0 aperture | BATTERY: 4,200mAh (Typical Value) | WATER PROOFING: IP68

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